

Claude Code — Master Ideas List

Every game idea and every coding/backend idea from this project in one place, for reference across Claude Code sessions. Not a single task — a roadmap to pull individual briefs from.

STANDING INSTRUCTION FOR EVERY SESSION: While building any of this, actively flag genuinely lucrative or clever ideas that surface from seeing the intricacies of these businesses up close — pricing angles, cross-promotion between M.P. Radio/Market Guides/M.P. Productions, technical shortcuts with real business upside, anything a builder would naturally spot that a non-technical planning conversation wouldn't. Don't just execute the brief silently — speak up when something genuinely valuable comes into view.

PART 1 — GAMES

Already Built and Tested (do not rebuild)

- Pool — Practice, 2-Player Hotseat, Points Challenge modes; real physics including Spin/English
- Snooker — full 22-ball setup, real rule enforcement (red/color alternation, colors-in-order endgame)
- Darts (501, double-out) — real dartboard geometry and scoring, all bust rules verified
- Pinball — real flippers (variable strength), bumpers, launch lane, branded visuals
- Sling Smash — original slingshot-physics game (Angry Birds-style mechanic, original characters/branding)
- An arcade hub page linking all five games under one branded front door

Planned — 1980s Arcade Classics (not yet started)

- Breakout-style (paddle + ball + destructible bricks) — was about to start when paused; reuses ball-physics patterns already proven in Pinball/Sling Smash
- Pac-Man-style maze chaser (grid navigation, chasing AI)
- Space Invaders/Galaga-style shooter (enemy waves, projectile shooting)
- Frogger-style crossing game
- Tetris-style falling block puzzle (grid logic, piece rotation, line clearing)

Standing Rules for Any New Game

- Each game needs its own distinct sound effects, music, and confetti — never copy-pasted from another game
- Build one game fully, test it thoroughly with real interaction (not just visual inspection), before starting the next
- Keep the same self-contained single-HTML-file approach unless a game specifically needs the shared backend (see Part 2)

PART 2 — BACKEND / CODING SYSTEMS

1. Shared Arcade Leaderboard (start here — smallest, most self-contained)

- A real database and small API so all five (eventually more) games share one persistent, cross-device leaderboard instead of each game's isolated localStorage score

- Needed for the "businesses give prizes to top scorers" vendor-sponsorship model to actually work
- Full separate brief already written for this one specifically

2. Manager QR-Code / MLM Referral System

- QR code tied to a manager's unique UpPromote affiliate link — scanning it signs an artist up already attached to that manager
- UpPromote handles the actual MLM commission/network logic (unlimited sub-affiliate depth, native Network dashboard tab, real developer API available on the Professional plan)
- RESOLVED — referral structure simplified after further review: a single-tier "Direct Referral Reward," a flat \$5 cash payout for a direct signup only, with no bonus for anything that person later brings in themselves. This avoids the earlier legal question entirely (multi-tier structures risk resembling a pyramid scheme when payouts are triggered by someone else's recruitment rather than an actual sale) and does not require UpPromote's paid Professional tier — the Free plan or Shopify's own native discount codes can run this. A separate, non-cash "value-add ecosystem" (virtual real estate, merch discounts, studio time, Golden Pass perks) is planned for artist retention/reward, deliberately kept independent of the referral mechanism so it never touches the legal question. UpPromote's MLM/multi-tier features remain available if a real multi-tier structure is ever built later, but that is not the current plan
- Rebrandly (connected via Zapier) can wrap the UpPromote link in a branded domain instead of UpPromote's own

3. Custom Backend Dashboard — Controlling UpPromote & Hosting Architecture

The goal: every manager/artist dashboard, including UpPromote's own stats and network view, rebuilt inside the platform's own custom backend — no one ever logs into uppromote.com directly. This section is deliberately detailed since it's the technical core of the whole system.

UpPromote API Integration — Specifics

- Requires UpPromote's Professional plan (\$89.99/month) or higher — the API key is not available on Free or Growth tiers
- Base API: `aff-api.uppromote.com` — server-side calls only, the API key must never be exposed to the browser/frontend
- Key data to pull: affiliate list (managers + their sub-affiliates), referral records, commission/network totals per affiliate, coupon data
- Subscribe to webhooks rather than only polling: `affiliate.new` (fires on signup — use this to trigger your own account provisioning), `referral.new`, `referral.approved`, `referral.status-changed` (use these to keep your own dashboard's numbers current in near real time instead of stale cached data)
- Cache UpPromote responses in your own database rather than calling their API on every dashboard page load — treat UpPromote as the source of truth that syncs into your system, not something your frontend queries live
- Your own database needs at minimum: a table mapping your internal user IDs to UpPromote affiliate IDs, and a table logging incoming webhook events so nothing is lost if a webhook delivery fails and needs reprocessing

Verpex Hosting — Deployment Specifics

- Plan on file: Verpex Start-Up Reseller — up to 15 cPanel accounts, 50GB NVMe SSD, unlimited bandwidth
- cPanel supports Node.js app hosting directly (via the "Setup Node.js App" tool in cPanel) — this is where the backend service itself runs
- Database: cPanel includes MySQL/MariaDB management — use this for the production database rather than SQLite once this moves past the initial leaderboard prototype, since UpPromote sync data and multi-tenant dashboard data both need real concurrent-access support
- Each client site needing its own cPanel account (per the 15-account reseller limit) should be planned deliberately — the core M.P. Radio/Market Guides backend likely needs its own dedicated account rather than sharing one with client sites
- SSL and custom domains (for Rebrandly-branded manager links, and for the platform's own domain) are managed through cPanel's SSL/TLS and domain tools directly
- API keys (UpPromote, Stripe, etc.) belong in environment variables on the server, never committed to code or exposed in any frontend file

4. CP24-Style TV Screen Backend

- Multi-user video/graphic upload system for the CP24-style multi-panel video format
- Needs real account permissions — the owner plus at least one other person able to upload content
- Ties into the draft programming schedule (kids' content 6am-12pm, nature content after, radio audio throughout, arcade games woven in for retention)

5. Discord-Style Roster Backend

- District managers overseeing artists/managers, each with their own backend view of only their roster
- A live feed/chat component — resembling Discord's structure — plus a separate live chat specifically for when the radio is playing
- Artists can submit new songs/content directly into this system for the group to push across platforms

6. Scroll-Cinematic Website ("Scroll World")

- Higgsfield-generated hero image + video clips → frame extraction → Lenis scroll-scrubbing → full cinematic site
- Confirmed to require Claude Code specifically via Higgsfield MCP integration — does not run in standard chat
- Status: Higgsfield not yet connected/purchased

7. Artist-Hosted Sites

- For artists who choose to pay for their own site hosting rather than use the platform's default profile
- Still needs discovery: what specifically these artists want/need in a standalone site before this can be scoped as a real build

8. Shopify — The Commerce Backbone for All Three Brands

Already live at market-guides.myshopify.com with draft M.P. Radio tier products created. This section preps Shopify to actually perform across Market Guides, M.P. Productions, and M.P. Radio together — not three separate stores, one commerce backbone serving all three.

The One Critical Fact — Recurring Billing

- A plain Shopify product is a ONE-TIME purchase. It cannot charge \$10/month, \$20/month, or \$25/month on its own
- Real recurring billing requires Shopify Subscriptions (free, native) or a third-party subscription app, built on Selling Plan Groups — this must be set up before any tier can actually charge monthly
- Every M.P. Radio tier (the \$10 base, \$20 DJ, \$25 Extra, and whatever manager tier pricing gets decided) needs its own Selling Plan attached, not just a product listing

Market Guides — What Shopify Needs to Handle

- Company/vendor listings and the virtual booth tiers from the vendor program
- The three completed ebooks and the 20 apparel designs as sellable products, once Artistly covers are generated
- Virtual real estate purchases (rooms, booths, buildings) — likely needs custom product types or metafields to represent a non-physical, tour-linked product
- The coupon booklet's codes represented as real Shopify discount codes so redemption can be tracked

M.P. Productions — What Shopify Needs to Handle

- Print brokerage products (the \$150 mini-magazine add-on, business cards, and the rest of the real print pricing already on file in the project's Printfast/Printing Details documents)
- Photography/videography/green-screen add-on packages
- "Golden Pass" discount codes — Shopify's native discount code system can drive this directly, potentially as a customer tag/segment (buildable via Sidekick's natural-language discount/segment creation) rather than custom code

M.P. Radio — What Shopify Needs to Handle

- All subscription tiers via Selling Plan Groups (see above) — this is the priority item for this brand specifically
- "Buy Dubs" per-artist purchases and CD Baby / Full Release Package bundle as a one-time-offer product in the post-signup upsell flow
- OTO upsell flow with countdown timers — Shopify's native checkout doesn't do this alone; needs a post-purchase upsell app (e.g., ReConvert) or custom checkout extension
- Exit-intent discount trigger — needs an app (e.g., Privy, OptinMonster) or custom theme-level script, since this isn't a native Shopify feature

Shopify's Own AI Tools — Confirmed Current Capability

- Shopify Magic: free, built into admin, generates product descriptions, marketing copy, emails, and images — directly useful for the ebook listings, apparel descriptions, and print product copy
- Shopify Sidekick: free, a conversational AI agent (not just buttons) that can create discount codes and customer segments, and build Shopify Flow automations from a plain-language description — worth using directly to build the Golden Pass discount logic and family-discount coupon system rather than custom-coding it
- Both are already included in the existing plan — no additional cost to start using either

Cross-Brand Integration Points

- UpPromote already runs as a Shopify app — its affiliate/referral tracking ties directly into purchases made through this same store, so the subscription and referral systems share one checkout, not two separate ones
- Stripe is already connected — confirm it's set as a payment processor on the actual Shopify checkout, not just connected as a standalone tool

9. Distribution & Streaming Platform Integration

Confirmed technical capability per platform — real gaps included honestly rather than assumed away.

- CD Baby: NO public developer API, SDK, or automation path exists — confirmed directly. All distribution and reporting runs through the human member portal (members.cdbaby.com) only. Any CD Baby integration into the custom backend has to be manual data entry/export, not a live API sync
- SoundCloud: has a real developer API, but access now requires submitting a developer application and being approved — no longer open by default. Apply early if this is planned, since approval isn't instant
- Podbean: has a real, confirmed API for podcast hosting/distribution management — a genuine automation candidate for the thetimewelivein.com interview content
- Mixcloud: covered in full separately (see the Mixcloud Exposure Strategy document) — Host Tagging, genre tags, Posts, and Stats (Pro tier) are all real, confirmed features
- Live365: already an active subscription, but its API capability was not confirmed in this pass — verify directly before assuming any automation path exists
- Bandcamp: an existing, real handle already in use (mrpersonality1.bandcamp.com) — confirmed current use, not just proposed
- YouTube, Twitch, Instagram, Facebook: all four are already actively used for livestreaming — confirmed current use, relevant to the plan to continuously play artist content across platforms for royalty collection
- SoundCloud and Podbean: both were raised as platforms to add to the services list, not yet confirmed as currently in active use — treat as planned additions, with SoundCloud specifically needing a developer application submitted early given the approval-gated API access confirmed above

10. Design References — What to Actually Borrow From Each

Naming a comparison alone isn't enough guidance — here's the specific element intended from each one.

- **MySpace** (classic era): the customizable, personality-driven artist profile page — not the dated visual style itself, but the feeling that an artist's page is genuinely theirs, not a generic template everyone shares
- **Voices.com**: the post-a-job / audition-matching flow — a promoter or client posts what they need, talent responds or gets matched, rather than only browsing a static directory
- **Fiverr**: the browse-and-book packaged-service model — clear tiers, clear prices, book directly without a back-and-forth negotiation
- **Kijiji**: the low-friction, fast classifieds-style listing/posting experience — relevant to Market Guides' vendor listings specifically, where ease of posting matters more than heavy customization
- **CP24** (Bell Media, Toronto) — LAYOUT first, look second: **Layout** (the structural priority): a main video feed running alongside simultaneous side panels (headlines, weather, stock-ticker-style info) plus a scrolling ticker banner at the bottom carrying good news from around the world specifically, not

general/mixed news — written in the accessible, punchy style of the Sunday Sun, but with the journalistic substance/credibility of CBC. Refined further: ticker content should be multi-language, and also carry weather and stock information alongside the good-news content. This is confirmed as a complete TV station, not just a video-enhanced radio format — planned sections so far: a children's section named 'Fantasy World,' an arcade section, and at least one more section still to be decided. Also confirmed sellable/relevant to performers themselves, not just viewers — a genuine multi-panel screen division, not a single video player with overlays on top. Build this panel structure itself first, since it's also the literal foundation for the eventual TV-station pivot. **Look** (secondary, applied within that structure): the specific colors, fonts, and styling — this should follow the platform's own brand rules (Section 2 brand standards) rather than copying CP24's own visual skin

- **Mureka multi-language singer service:** leveraging Mureka's confirmed multilingual accuracy advantage over Suno for a real service offering to artists
- **Online karaoke feature:** Zoom (or similar video conferencing) for the live room, paired with a Watch2Gether-style synced-playback method for the backing track/lyrics — ties into the existing theatre/stage booking option; Mureka could generate multi-language instrumental backing tracks on demand as a genuine differentiator beyond existing YouTube karaoke content
- **Bigo Live as a revenue stream:** a real official Agency/Reseller program exists (5 tiers, \$145-\$2,950 registration, all figures in confirmed USD) — performers earn a share of gift revenue, agency earns a cut. Commission percentage has an unresolved discrepancy between sources (20-40% vs 20-55%) — confirm directly with Bigo before quoting either figure. Decided: charge performers via a higher subscription tier for agency access/coaching, not a separate flat fee. IMPORTANT — three related ideas were checked and do NOT hold up: Bigo has no confirmed white-label option (the reseller program still runs on Bigo's own branded app), no confirmed embed API for hosting the stream on another site (unlike Twitch/YouTube), and no technical connection to UpPromote exists at all (UpPromote is Shopify-only; any 'split via UpPromote' would be manual bookkeeping, not real automation). Do not build toward embedding, white-labeling, or automating this via UpPromote without first getting this directly confirmed with Bigo

10. 3D Kart Racer (future Claude Code project)

- A 2D top-down version ("Turbo Karts") is already built and tested in chat — same genre as Mario Kart (racing, items, laps), original karts and track, no copyrighted characters
- A true 3D version — behind-the-kart camera, real 3D track and kart models — is a genuinely bigger undertaking, needing a real 3D engine (e.g. Three.js), not a simple style change
- Deserves its own dedicated Claude Code session with real iteration time, not something to build in a single sitting

11. Design Reference Tool for This Build — Refero

CONFIRMED (directly from Refero's own site, not third-party): use Refero, not Mobbin, as the design reference tool for this build specifically.

- Refero is web and iOS focused specifically — matches this build (website, manager dashboard, CP24 layout) better than Mobbin's broader, mobile-app-heavy library
- Searches at the component level: filterable by exact page type (Pricing, Checkout, Dashboard) and individual UI elements (Navigation, Modal, Data Table, Footer) — directly useful for the manager/district-manager dashboard specifically

- Install as an actual Claude Skill (confirmed, official): **npx skills add https://github.com/referodesign/refero_skill** — this changes the agent's own workflow: research real references first, extract specific patterns, then design following craft rules for typography, color, spacing, and motion, rather than jumping straight to code
- Paid tier includes both the Skill and full MCP server access for the AI agent, confirmed as one combined offering
- Requires Refero's paid plan (exact price not yet confirmed — check refero.design/pricing before starting)

Already Simple/Done — No Claude Code Needed

- The web payout calculator (50/50 split) — already built as a self-contained HTML/JS embed
- All five games' front-ends — done, tested, working as standalone files